Reading

Ramayya was a simple man living in the town. He lived with his wife in a nice house made of tiled roofs. He was not rich but he could take care of his family.



Two sparrows built a nest in a nice spot in the roof of Ramayya's house and the mother bird laid her eggs in it.

"My dear," began the male sparrow.

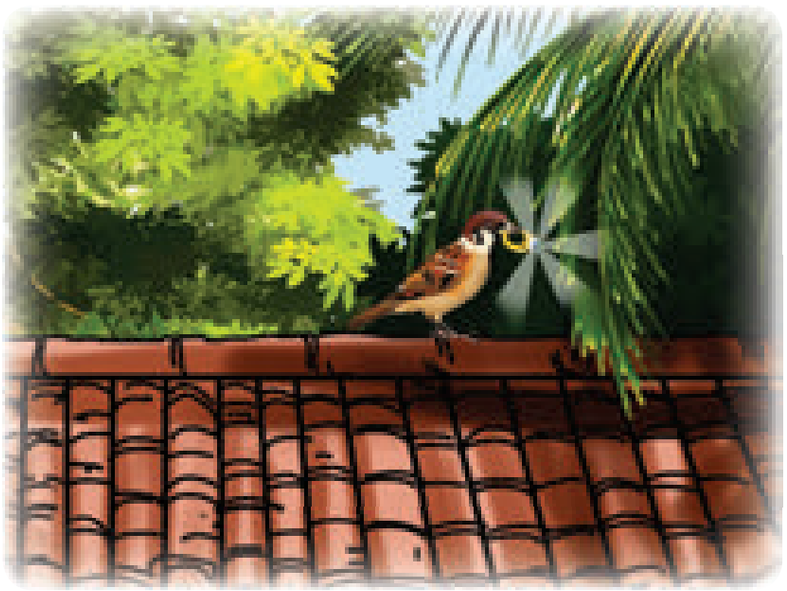
"And what do you want now?" asked his wife.

"Why does the lady of this house always quarrel with her husband?"

"How am I to know?" said the female bird. "Let us mind our own business."

"You are always **self-centred**," said the male sparrow and added, "Should we not help this poor Ramayya?"

The female sparrow said with **disdain**, "Let me see what help you can do for him. Please do not talk about what does not concern us. See that the cat does not come near our nest. That would be enough for you and me."



Somewhere in the **muck-heap** lay a diamond nose-jewel. The male bird picked it up and came to the nest with the shining stud in his beak and said to his wife: "Look! Do you like this?

The wife bird replied, "What am I to do with diamond nose studs or with ear-rings? Find some **grub**; the young ones are hungry."

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